6.9 Appendicitis and Appendectomy*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "The pain started around my navel and moved to the right side." • Rates pain 8/10 **Objective** • Tender right lower quadrant • Temperature 38.2 °C • Raised white cell count	**ACTUAL** Acute pain related to inflammation of the appendix as evidenced by right lower quadrant pain and tenderness.	• Pain at or below 3/10 before and after surgery.	• Keep him nil by mouth; give IV fluids as ordered. • Give analgesia as prescribed. • Let him lie with the knees slightly bent. • No heat to the abdomen and no laxatives. • Report sudden relief followed by pain all over the abdomen, as this may mean perforation.	• Outcome reached when pain is controlled.
Subjective • "Will it be a big operation?" **Objective** • Looks anxious • Repeats questions	**ACTUAL** Excessive anxiety related to emergency surgery as evidenced by worry and repeated questioning.	• Understands the operation and feels less anxious.	• Explain the procedure and the recovery. • Carry out pre-operative preparation calmly. • Allow family to stay.	• Considered met when he is calmer.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Inflamed or perforated appendix • Surgical incision	**RISK** Risk for infection as evidenced by risk factors: possible perforation and surgical incision.	• No wound infection or abscess.	• Give antibiotics as prescribed. • Watch temperature, wound and abdominal pain. • Mobilize early.	• Goal reached if no infection develops.

* **References for this care plan:** [7], [32], [35], [37]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.